

ROLE: Digital Marketing Specialist / Executive

OVERVIEW

Digital Marketing Specialists plan, execute, and optimize a brand's online presence across social media, search engines, email, and paid advertising platforms. They translate business goals into digital campaigns that generate awareness, engagement, and leads. In B2B contexts — particularly in IT services, SaaS, and fintech — digital marketers also support lead generation through LinkedIn outreach, cold email, and content marketing. Modern digital marketing increasingly involves AI tools for content creation, campaign optimization, audience analysis, and workflow automation. This is a creative and analytical role that requires both writing ability and data literacy.

CORE RESPONSIBILITIES

- Develop and execute digital marketing strategies across social media, email, search, and paid advertising
- Plan and manage content calendars for LinkedIn, Instagram, and other platforms
- Write captions, post copy, marketing emails, and short-form content
- Coordinate with designers, videographers, and content creators through clear creative briefs
- Plan and manage paid advertising campaigns on Meta Ads and Google Ads
- Monitor engagement, audience growth, and campaign performance using analytics tools
- Support B2B lead generation through LinkedIn outreach and email campaigns
- Research potential clients and decision-makers for outreach targeting
- Maintain lead trackers and CRM records with contact status and follow-up dates
- Prepare daily, weekly, and monthly performance reports
- Stay updated on platform algorithm changes, digital marketing trends, and AI advancements
- Utilize AI-powered tools to enhance content planning, research, and campaign management

SOCIAL MEDIA MANAGEMENT

Social media is the most visible part of digital marketing. Specialists manage the brand's presence across platforms — LinkedIn for B2B professional positioning and lead generation, Instagram for visual brand building and consumer engagement. The job involves both strategy (what to post and why) and execution (writing, scheduling, coordinating creatives, tracking performance). Content calendars ensure consistency; without them, posting becomes reactive and inconsistent.

- Planning and managing daily posts for LinkedIn, Instagram, and other platforms
- Preparing weekly and monthly content calendars aligned to business goals
- Writing captions, hashtags, post copy, and calls-to-action for each platform
- Giving clear design briefs to graphic designers with headline, layout idea, and CTA
- Coordinating creatives including reels, carousels, static posts, and story banners
- Ensuring all content follows brand tone, visual identity, and business positioning
- Tracking engagement metrics — reach, impressions, likes, comments, shares, saves
- A/B testing content formats, posting times, and copy styles
- Adapting platform strategies as algorithms and best practices evolve

CONTENT PLANNING AND CREATION

Content is what attracts, educates, and converts an audience. For B2B and SaaS brands, content must translate complex product features into simple business-value language. The best digital marketers think like journalists — they find stories in product updates, customer use cases, industry trends, and founder perspectives. Content types vary: product explainers, feature highlights, industry insights, founder posts, testimonials, and lead generation posts each serve different funnel stages.

- Creating content ideas around the brand's industry vertical (fintech, SaaS, IT services, payments)
- Converting technical product features into simple, benefit-focused messaging
- Planning content mix: educational posts, product content, social proof, engagement posts
- Writing long-form LinkedIn articles, thought leadership posts, and newsletter content

- Scripting short video content and reels for Instagram and LinkedIn
- Researching competitor and industry content for inspiration and differentiation
- Maintaining a content bank of evergreen posts, templates, and copy assets
- Repurposing content across formats — blog to LinkedIn post, video to carousel

LINKEDIN OUTREACH AND B2B LEAD GENERATION

In B2B digital marketing, LinkedIn is both a content platform and a lead generation channel. Specialists research target companies and decision-makers, send connection requests with personalized notes, and follow up with prospects who engage. The goal is to generate qualified interest and hand off warm leads to sales or senior management. This requires research discipline, writing ability for cold outreach, and systematic follow-up using a lead tracker.

- Researching target companies and decision-maker profiles (CEOs, founders, CTOs, product heads)
- Sending personalized LinkedIn connection requests and introduction messages
- Following up with engaged prospects and coordinating meetings with senior management
- Maintaining a lead tracker with company name, contact, status, and next follow-up date
- Building prospect lists from LinkedIn, company websites, directories, and online research
- Writing LinkedIn cold outreach messages that focus on business value, not product pitches
- Segmenting prospects by industry, company size, and decision-maker role
- Tracking connection acceptance rates, reply rates, and meeting conversion rates

EMAIL MARKETING

Email remains one of the highest-ROI digital marketing channels, particularly for B2B. Effective email marketing requires building clean prospect lists, writing subject lines and body copy that get opened and read, and following up systematically. Cold email outreach for B2B lead generation is distinct from newsletter marketing — it is shorter, more direct, and focused on getting a reply rather than a click.

- Building prospect email lists through LinkedIn, website research, and directories
- Writing cold outreach emails with clear value propositions and specific calls-to-action
- Preparing newsletter and product update emails for existing contacts and subscribers
- Setting up email sequences and automated follow-up workflows
- A/B testing subject lines, email length, and call-to-action phrasing
- Tracking open rates, click-through rates, reply rates, and unsubscribe rates
- Managing email tools such as Mailchimp, Brevo (Sendinblue), HubSpot, or Zoho Campaigns
- Maintaining list hygiene — removing bounces, unsubscribes, and inactive contacts
- Ensuring CAN-SPAM and GDPR compliance in all email communications

PAID ADVERTISING — META AND GOOGLE ADS

Paid advertising amplifies organic content and drives targeted traffic, leads, or conversions. Meta Ads (Facebook and Instagram) are powerful for B2C and brand awareness campaigns using interest and demographic targeting. Google Ads capture high-intent search traffic. Both platforms require understanding of campaign structure, audience targeting, bidding strategies, and performance optimization. Budget management and ROAS (Return on Ad Spend) tracking are core responsibilities.

- Setting up and managing Meta Ads campaigns across Facebook and Instagram
- Building audience segments using interest targeting, lookalike audiences, and retargeting
- Setting up Google Ads search campaigns with keyword research and match types
- Writing ad copy and headlines optimized for click-through and conversion
- Managing daily and monthly ad budgets across campaigns
- Monitoring campaign metrics — CPM, CPC, CTR, CPA, ROAS, and conversion rate
- Optimizing underperforming ads by adjusting targeting, creative, and bidding
- Setting up Meta Pixel and Google Tag Manager for conversion tracking
- Running A/B tests on ad creatives, headlines, and audience segments

- Generating performance reports and presenting insights to management

SEO — SEARCH ENGINE OPTIMIZATION

SEO drives organic (unpaid) traffic from search engines to a website. It involves optimizing website content for search intent, building backlinks, improving technical site health, and tracking keyword rankings. For B2B and SaaS companies, SEO builds long-term inbound pipeline — prospects find the product through search rather than outbound prospecting.

- Keyword research using tools like Google Keyword Planner, Ahrefs, or SEMrush
- On-page SEO: optimizing title tags, meta descriptions, headers, and content
- Content SEO: writing or planning blog posts and landing pages targeting search intent
- Technical SEO basics: site speed, mobile responsiveness, crawlability, and structured data
- Link building through partnerships, guest posts, and directory listings
- Local SEO for location-based businesses (Google Business Profile optimization)
- Tracking keyword rankings, organic traffic, and search visibility in Google Search Console
- Competitor SEO analysis to identify content and keyword gaps

ANALYTICS AND PERFORMANCE REPORTING

Data is what separates effective digital marketers from those who are just active. Every campaign, post, and outreach sequence should be measured against clear KPIs. Analytics tells you what is working, what is not, and where to allocate budget and effort next. Good reporting translates numbers into insights and recommendations — not just raw data.

- Setting up and using Google Analytics 4 for website traffic and conversion tracking
- Tracking social media metrics in Meta Business Suite, LinkedIn Analytics, and Instagram Insights
- Building weekly and monthly performance dashboards in Google Sheets or Looker Studio
- Defining KPIs for each channel: engagement rate, reach, lead volume, cost per lead
- Identifying trends and anomalies in campaign performance data
- Presenting findings and recommendations to management with context and next steps
- Attribution analysis to understand which channels and campaigns drive leads

AI TOOLS IN DIGITAL MARKETING

AI tools are transforming how digital marketing work gets done. Content that used to take hours can be drafted in minutes. Audience insights that required manual analysis are now automated. Digital marketers who use AI tools effectively have a significant productivity and creative advantage. This is now an explicit hiring requirement at forward-looking companies.

- Using AI writing tools (ChatGPT, Claude, Jasper, Copy.ai) for drafting captions, emails, and ad copy
- Using AI image generation tools (Midjourney, DALL-E, Adobe Firefly) for creative concepts
- Using AI for content research, topic ideation, and competitor analysis
- Automating repetitive tasks (scheduling, reporting, list building) with AI-powered workflows
- Using AI-powered analytics tools for audience segmentation and campaign optimization
- Leveraging LinkedIn Sales Navigator with AI features for prospect research
- Staying updated on platform-native AI features in Meta Ads, Google Ads, and Canva
- Prompt engineering — knowing how to instruct AI tools to get useful marketing outputs
- Reviewing and editing AI-generated content for brand accuracy and human authenticity

TOOLS AND PLATFORMS

Proficiency in core marketing tools is a baseline expectation. The more tools a specialist can use without training, the faster they add value in a new role.

- Canva for graphic design and creative asset production
- Meta Business Suite for scheduling posts and managing Facebook and Instagram ads
- LinkedIn Campaign Manager for LinkedIn ads and outreach management

- Google Ads for search and display campaign management
- Google Analytics 4 for website performance tracking
- Google Search Console for SEO monitoring
- Mailchimp, Brevo, or HubSpot for email marketing and automation
- HubSpot, Zoho CRM, or Google Sheets for lead tracking and CRM
- Hootsuite, Buffer, or Later for social media scheduling
- Ahrefs or SEMrush for SEO and keyword research
- Google Looker Studio for marketing dashboards and reporting
- Notion or Trello for content calendar and campaign planning

ENTRY LEVEL EXPECTATIONS

At entry level (0–2 years), digital marketers focus on execution — posting content, coordinating creatives, managing outreach sequences, and tracking performance in spreadsheets. Learning the platforms deeply and building campaign intuition are the main development goals. Strong written English and self-direction are critical — managers cannot write every caption and follow up on every lead.

- Managing social media posting and content calendar execution
- Writing captions, marketing emails, and LinkedIn outreach messages
- Coordinating with designers using clear, structured creative briefs
- Researching leads and maintaining the lead tracker
- Basic Meta Business Suite and LinkedIn management
- Sending LinkedIn connection requests and email outreach daily
- Preparing simple weekly performance reports
- Using Canva for basic creative edits

INTERMEDIATE LEVEL EXPECTATIONS

At intermediate level (2–4 years), specialists independently run paid ad campaigns, own the content strategy for assigned channels, manage lead generation pipelines, and produce performance insights. They can set up tracking, optimize campaigns, and mentor junior team members or coordinate freelancers.

- Running and optimizing Meta Ads and Google Ads campaigns independently
- Owning content strategy and calendar for LinkedIn and Instagram
- Managing email marketing campaigns end-to-end including list building and sequencing
- LinkedIn lead generation with documented outreach metrics and conversion rates
- SEO keyword research and content planning for organic growth
- Building analytics dashboards and presenting monthly performance reports
- CRM management and lead lifecycle tracking in HubSpot or Zoho
- Using AI tools to increase content output and campaign efficiency

ADVANCED LEVEL EXPECTATIONS

At senior level (4+ years), digital marketing specialists lead multi-channel strategy, manage budgets across platforms, and align marketing activity to business revenue goals. They hire and manage teams, work with agencies, and make decisions on channel mix and technology stack.

- Multi-channel digital marketing strategy and annual planning
- Managing significant ad budgets with clear ROAS accountability
- Leading content, paid, SEO, and email functions simultaneously
- Building and managing a team of junior marketers and freelancers
- Marketing technology stack evaluation and implementation
- Attribution modelling and full-funnel performance analysis
- Direct collaboration with founders and senior management on growth strategy

CERTIFICATIONS THAT MATTER

- Google Digital Marketing and E-commerce Certificate (Google Career Certificates)
- Meta Certified Digital Marketing Associate
- HubSpot Content Marketing Certification (free)
- HubSpot Email Marketing Certification (free)
- Google Ads Search Certification (free via Google Skillshop)
- SEMrush SEO Toolkit Course and Certification (free)
- LinkedIn Marketing Labs Certifications (free)
- Hootsuite Social Marketing Certification

COMMON PROJECTS FOR PORTFOLIO

A portfolio matters more than a degree in digital marketing. Real results — follower growth, lead numbers, ad performance metrics — are what employers look at.

- LinkedIn company page growth project with documented follower and engagement growth
- Email outreach campaign with open rate, reply rate, and meeting booked metrics
- Meta Ads campaign case study showing targeting approach and ROAS achieved
- SEO content project — blog posts ranking on Google for target keywords
- Content calendar built for a brand (even a personal or student project)
- Social media audit and strategy document for a real or mock brand
- Lead generation tracker showing prospect pipeline managed end-to-end

LEARNING ROADMAP FOR DIGITAL MARKETING

Start with Google's free Digital Marketing and E-commerce Certificate on Coursera — it covers the fundamentals across all channels. Then get hands-on: create a LinkedIn company page or Instagram account for a mock brand and manage it for 30 days. Run a small Meta Ads campaign with a minimal budget (even Rs. 500) to understand the platform. Learn Canva for design basics. Get HubSpot's free certifications for email and content marketing. Build a simple portfolio with 2–3 case studies showing what you did and what results were achieved. Apply for internships or junior roles in digital agencies, SaaS startups, or fintech companies for real-world exposure.

RELATED ROLES

- Social Media Manager
- Content Marketing Manager
- Growth Marketer
- Performance Marketing Specialist (Paid Ads focus)
- SEO Specialist
- Email Marketing Specialist
- Brand Manager
- Marketing Analyst
- Product Marketing Manager
- LinkedIn Lead Generation Specialist